

Esteban *Gimenez Zapiola*

CREATIVE DIRECTOR & CREATIVE AI LEAD · BCG

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I run design as a business that drives revenue,
and I built the Creative AI practice that scales it:
33 nodes, a lab of 10, 24 builders in squads.

I lead design as a commercial capability that moves revenue, and I built the Creative AI practice that scales it. As Creative Director at BCG I own the ANZ Creative Studio P&L, sit on the global leadership team, and lead the Creative AI practice across **33 nodes in the regions** and a **global lab of 10 creative technologists**, with reach into 400+ designers. I work **embedded in the case team**, hands-on alongside MDPs, BCG X engineers and the client's own technical people.

I founded the practice and authored the "*Creative Advantage*" proposal positioning it as the firm's Creative AI centre of excellence. I build agentic AI hands-on and take it to production, but the building is how I lead: I write the first working version so the direction is arguable rather than theoretical, then hand it to people who take it further.

| *Design isn't art. It's a discipline that moves revenue.*

EXPERIENCE

Nov 2024 – Present

BCG · Boston
Consulting Group

Sydney · Global

Creative Director & Creative AI Lead

- Founded and lead BCG Design Studios' **Creative AI practice**, and authored the "*Creative Advantage*" proposal positioning it as the firm's Creative AI centre of excellence.
- Lead **33 Creative AI nodes across the regions** and a **global lab of 10 creative technologists**, taking tools from proof-of-concept to working internal product. Designed the structure, defined the roles and wrote the playbook so a node runs without me.
- **Orchestrated 24 builders across squads** to ship a seven-product self-serve suite for senior partners, delivered with handover docs and briefed to named owners in other regions.
- Designed and ran the **Power Up Weeks region by region** through the regional leads, wrote and deliver the deep-dive curriculum (graph and context engineering, prompting, agent loops, building agents in Claude and GPT), and ran a **global Creative AI hackathon** end to end out of London, now a shared library of **49 skills** behind an automated review pipeline.
- **Embedded and hands-on in client delivery**, alongside MDPs, **BCG X data scientists and engineers** and the client's own technical team. I lead the coded proof-of-concept **inside the pitch rather than after it**, bridging studio and case team, and **multiple proposals have been won that way** across agri-food, energy, convenience retail, beverages and banking. The win is never one person's. It is what happens when deep BCG strategy is combined with design and creative craft in the business, and it shows up as delivery and revenue rather than adjectives.
- Build and ship **agentic AI hands-on**: multi-agent systems, MCP servers, autonomous agents, a native macOS app, an AI video pipeline, and a report engine that typesets long-form publications from their source document.
- Lead the global practice across **six disciplines** and **400+ designers**, own the **ANZ Creative Studio P&L**, sit on the global Design Studios leadership team, and hold BCG's "*Grow by Growing Others*" award. Pitched, launched and executive-produce **Business and Beyond**, BCG ANZ's flagship video podcast.
- **Outcomes**: 9–13% YoY revenue growth · ~2× regional scale · ~80% cross-border delivery · double-digit conversion lifts · 33 nodes and a lab of 10 · 24 builders orchestrated.

Nov 2021 – Oct 2024

BCG · Boston
Consulting Group

Sydney

Senior Creative Manager

Head of Creative ANZ & Co-Lead, Strategy ANZ. Built the foundation for the Global role.

- Grew ANZ Creative into one of BCG's strongest regional design practices; creative strategy contributing to **9–13% YoY revenue growth** across financial services, energy, retail, public sector, healthcare and tech.
- Co-led ANZ business strategy, at the table for positioning, growth and investment decisions; partnered with MDs, Partners and C-suite to shape transformation programs. Treated design as a commercial lever, not a service.
- Began embedding AI into the creative workflow and built a mentorship-driven culture, growing senior designers into leaders and the bench that earned the Global mandate.

Jun 2018 – Nov 2021

Endeavour Group

Sydney

Creative Lead, Endeavour Drinks · *Dan Murphy's*

Creative Lead for Dan Murphy's, Australia's #1 drinks retailer; also across BWS.

- Helped grow a small in-house team into a full **in-house agency** serving the entire Endeavour portfolio, the era when digital and retail first collided.
- Built and governed the Dan Murphy's **Design System** (Frontify, InVision), the single source of truth for print, digital and coded templates.
- Led the danmurphys.com.au **restyling** ($\approx 2\times$ audience) and the **Dan Murphy's app** launch; created sub-brands incl. Dan's Run (UberEats), Direct to Boot and Dan's Cellar.
- Led and mentored a team of 6 senior designers, and was the kind of leader people wanted to work for.

Jun 2015 – Jun 2018

Endeavour Group

Sydney

Senior Digital Designer

In-house digital at agency pace, across Dan Murphy's, BWS, Langtons and Cellarmasters.

- Hand-coded EDM templates and implemented dynamic personalisation on Oracle Responsys, the foundation of Dan Murphy's segmented email program.
- Produced wireframes and restyled core components of danmurphys.com.au; led art direction and on-location shoots for tier-1 campaigns, lifting digital ROI.

Aug 2011 – Aug 2015

Kasiopea · Brand Chemistry

Buenos Aires · Sydney

Senior UX/UI Designer

Generalist principal at a Buenos Aires digital agency (pharma, energy, talent, tech): art director, UX/UI designer, front-end developer, client lead and new-business pitcher. Clients incl. Duke Energy, Engie and Farmacity. Bridged to Brand Chemistry, Sydney.

2009 – 2012

Mendioroz Design · Crested Butte

Buenos Aires · Colorado

Graphic Designer · *Ski Instructor*

Visual identity and **wayfinding** for airports and shopping centres: signage systems, technical documentation and supplier oversight, where my interest in how design lives in physical space began. Plus three winter seasons as a PSIA-certified ski instructor, coaching beginners with patience.

CAPABILITIES

- Agentic AI, hands-on** · multi-agent systems, MCP servers, autonomous agents, a native app, prototype to production.
- Building the practice, not just the tool** · 33 nodes, a lab of 10 technologists, and 24 builders across squads who shipped a seven-product suite at my direction; playbooks and handover docs so it runs without me.
- Teaching it so it sticks** · Power Up Weeks run region by region, plus the deep dives I write and deliver.
- Design leadership at scale** · high-trust teams across regions and disciplines, coaching leaders into exceptional ones, across apps, websites, design systems, brand, journeys, editorial and motion.
- Strategic partnership & commercial design** · shoulder-to-shoulder with case teams, MDPs and the C-suite; owning a studio P&L, creative as a balance-sheet asset.

HONOURS

Grow by Growing *Others*

BOSTON CONSULTING GROUP

BCG award for leaders who lift the people around them: mentorship, and growing senior talent into leaders.

Ironman World Championship (*Hawaii*)

ELITE-AMATEUR TRIATHLETE

Multiple Ironman 70.3 age-group wins; qualified for the World Championship.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Mini-MBA, Business of Creativity · Future London Academy · 2025

Branding Now II · Future London Academy · 2022

Lic. Diseño de Imagen Empresaria · 2012–13 & Diseñador Gráfico · 2009–12 · Univ. de Palermo

Languages · Español (native) · English (full professional)